

Word family: **escape / escaped / escaping / escapee / escapism / escapist**

Base word: escape

Past tense: escaped

Past participle: escaped

Related forms: escapee, escapism, escapist

Useful extensions: fire escape, escape route, narrow escape, Escape key, escape room

Part of speech: verb(動詞) / noun(名詞)

Your sentence:

> “The headphones seemed like a small **escape** from everyday chaos.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **escape** is a **figurative noun**.

It means a temporary opportunity to get away mentally or emotionally from an unpleasant, stressful, or tiring situation.

繁體中文: **暫時從壓力、混亂或令人疲累的現實中抽離，得到片刻放鬆和喘息的機會**

中文翻譯:

> “The headphones seemed like a small escape from everyday chaos.”

「這副耳機就像讓人暫時從日常混亂中**抽離片刻、得到一點喘息和放鬆**。」

a small escape from everyday chaos = 從日常壓力和混亂中得到的一點短暫心理抽離／喘息

1. **escape from + danger/place/person(危險／地方／某人) — 逃離; 逃脫**

Meaning: To get away from a place, person, or dangerous situation where you are trapped, controlled, or threatened.

Practice 1

> “The family managed to **escape from** the burning building.”

「那家人成功**逃離失火的大樓**。」

Practice 2

> “The prisoner tried to **escape from** custody.”

「那名囚犯試圖**逃離羈押／逃脫拘留**。」

escape from = 成功離開原本被困、受控制或有危險的地方／處境

2. **escape = get away successfully (成功脫身) — 逃脫; 逃走**

The place or danger does not always need to be stated.

Practice 3

> “Two prisoners **escaped** during the night.”

「兩名囚犯在夜間**逃走了**。」

Practice 4

> “The driver **escaped** before the police arrived.”

「警方到達前，司機已經**逃離現場**。」

escape = 成功擺脫限制、追捕或危險並離開

3. **escape + danger/injury/death/punishment (危險／受傷／死亡／懲罰) — 逃過; 倖免於**

Meaning: To avoid experiencing something harmful or unpleasant.

Practice 5

> “She narrowly **escaped injury** in the accident.”

「她在事故中差一點受傷，最後**僥倖逃過受傷**。」

Practice 6

> “He cannot expect to **escape punishment**.”

「他不能期望**逃過懲罰**。」

****escape something unpleasant = 成功避免遭遇原本可能發生的危險、傷害、責任或懲罰****

Notice:

> ****escape from prison** = 從監獄逃走**

> ****escape punishment** = 逃過懲罰**

No ****from**** is needed in the second pattern.

4. ****escape + notice/attention/detection (注意／偵測) — 沒有被注意到; 逃過察覺****

****Meaning:**** To avoid being noticed, detected, or recognized.

Practice 7

> “The small error ****escaped**** everyone’s notice.”

「那個小錯誤****沒有被任何人注意到****。」

Practice 8

> “The problem ****escaped detection**** for several months.”

「這個問題幾個月來一直****沒有被偵測出來****。」

****escape notice/detection = 某事存在, 但成功避過別人的注意或偵測****

This is figurative: the error is not literally running away.

5. ****something escapes someone (記憶／答案) — 一時想不起; 記不起來****

A very useful figurative meaning.

****Meaning:**** For a fact, word, name, or detail to be impossible to remember at that moment.

Practice 9

> “His name ****escapes me**** at the moment.”

「我現在****一時想不起他的名字****。」

Practice 10

> “The exact date **escaped her**.”

「她**一時記不起確實日期**。」

something escapes me = 某項資料原本可能知道, 但當下就是想不起來

This is quite different from physical escape.

6. **gas/liquid/sound escapes** (氣體／液體／聲音) — 洩漏; 逸出

Meaning: To leak or pass out through an opening, often unintentionally.

Practice 11

> “Gas was **escaping** from the damaged pipe.”

「氣體正從損壞的喉管中**洩漏／逸出**。」

Practice 12

> “A little steam **escaped** when she opened the lid.”

「她打開蓋子時, 有少量蒸氣**逸了出來**。」

escape = 氣體、液體等從原本封閉的地方意外漏出或逸出

The same broad idea is still **getting out of confinement**.

7. **an escape** = act of getting away from danger/confinement (逃脫行動) — 逃脫; 逃走

Here, **escape** is a noun.

Practice 13

> “The police investigated the prisoner’s **escape**.”

「警方調查那名囚犯的**逃獄事件**。」

Practice 14

> “Their **escape** from the building took only a few minutes.”

「他們從大樓**逃生**只花了幾分鐘。」

an escape = 從受困、危險或限制中成功離開的行動／事件

8. **an escape from** + stress/routine/reality (日常壓力／例行生活／現實) — 暫時抽離；喘息

This is your original meaning.

Meaning: Something that allows a person to temporarily forget, avoid, or mentally step away from stress, routine, or unpleasant reality.

Practice 15 — Original

> “The headphones seemed like a small **escape from** everyday chaos.”

「這副耳機就像讓人從日常混亂中得到一點**短暫抽離和喘息**。」

Practice 16

> “Reading gives her an **escape from** the pressures of work.”

「閱讀讓她可以**暫時抽離工作壓力，得到放鬆**。」

Practice 17

> “The weekend trip was a welcome **escape from** routine.”

「週末旅行讓人可以**暫時離開一成不變的日常生活，得到難得的喘息**。」

an escape from something = 暫時在心理或實際生活上離開壓力、例行生活或不愉快的現實

9. **escape** = entertainment/activity used to forget reality (娛樂／活動) — 逃離現實的消遣；精神寄託

This is closely related to #8, but focuses on **the activity itself** as a recurring way to mentally get away.

Practice 18

> “Music became his main **escape** during a difficult year.”

「在艱難的一年裡，音樂成為他主要的**精神出口和暫時逃離現實的方式**。」

Practice 19

> “For many people, gaming provides an **escape**.”

「對很多人來說，打機提供了一種**暫時忘卻現實壓力的方式**。」

escape = 用來暫時忘記現實壓力、轉移注意力或獲得心理放鬆的活動

I would treat #8 and #9 as the **same broad figurative sense**, with different contexts.

10. **a narrow escape = very nearly experiencing disaster (驚險逃過) — 險些出事; 死裡逃生**

Meaning: A situation in which someone only just avoids danger, injury, or disaster.

Practice 20

> “That was a **narrow escape**.”

「那真是一次**驚險的逃過／差一點便出事**。」

Practice 21

> “They had a **narrow escape** when the tree fell beside the car.”

「那棵樹倒在車旁時，他們**差一點便被擊中，驚險逃過一劫**。」

narrow escape = 非常接近發生事故或受到傷害，但最後僥倖避過

11. **escape route (逃生路線) — 逃走／逃生的路線**

Meaning: A route that can be used to leave a dangerous or restricted place.

Practice 22

> “The emergency plan identifies every **escape route**.”

「緊急計劃標示了所有**逃生路線**。」

Practice 23

> “Never block an **escape route**.”

「切勿阻塞**逃生通道／路線**。」

escape route = 在危險或緊急情況下供人離開某地的安全路線

12. **fire escape** (建築物) — 消防逃生梯／緊急逃生樓梯

Meaning: A special external or emergency staircase used to leave a building during a fire or other emergency.

Practice 24

> “The building has a metal **fire escape** at the back.”

「大樓後方有一座金屬**消防逃生梯**。」

Practice 25

> “Keep the **fire escape** clear at all times.”

「任何時候都要保持**消防逃生通道**暢通。」

fire escape = 火警等緊急情況下供人離開建築物的專用逃生設施

13. **escapee** = person who has escaped (逃脫者／逃犯) — 逃脫者；逃走的人

Meaning: A person who has escaped from custody, confinement, or another controlled situation.

Practice 26

> “Police searched the area for the **escapee**.”

「警方在區內搜尋那名**逃脫者／逃犯**。」

Practice 27

> “The **escapees** were found several hours later.”

「那些**逃走的人**數小時後被找到。」

escapee = 已從拘留、監禁或受控制的地方成功逃走的人

14. **escapism** = habit of avoiding unpleasant reality through fantasy/entertainment — 逃避現實; 逃避主義

This is an excellent family extension for your original context.

Meaning: The tendency to seek distraction, fantasy, or entertainment in order to avoid thinking about unpleasant reality.

Practice 28

> “For him, films were a form of **escapism**.”

「對他來說，看電影是一種**暫時逃避現實壓力的方式**。」

Practice 29

> “The novel offers pure **escapism**.”

「這本小說提供了一種純粹的**逃離現實、沉浸於另一個世界的體驗**。」

escapism = 透過幻想、娛樂或其他活動暫時避開現實問題和壓力的傾向／做法

15. **escapist** = entertainment/activity designed to help people forget reality — 逃避現實式的; 讓人暫時脫離現實的

Here, **escapist** is an adjective.

Practice 30

> “The film is light, entertaining, and deliberately **escapist**.”

「這部電影輕鬆有娛樂性，而且刻意提供一種**讓觀眾暫時脫離現實的感覺**。」

Practice 31

> “She enjoys **escapist** fiction after a stressful day.”

「經過壓力很大的一天後，她喜歡閱讀**能讓人暫時忘記現實的小說**。」

escapist entertainment = 主要讓人暫時忘記日常現實和壓力的娛樂內容

16. **escapist** = person who tends to avoid reality/problems — 傾向逃避現實的人

Here, **escapist** can also be a noun.

Practice 32

> “He was accused of being an **escapist** rather than facing the problem.”

「有人批評他是個**傾向逃避現實問題的人**，而不是正面處理問題。」

Practice 33

> “Being imaginative does not necessarily make someone an **escapist**.”

「富有想像力並不代表一個人就是**逃避現實的人**。」

an escapist = 習慣透過幻想或其他方式避開現實問題的人

17. **Escape key**(電腦鍵盤) — Esc 鍵／退出鍵

This is a very common technology family extension.

Meaning: The keyboard key labelled **Esc**, often used to cancel, exit, close, or interrupt an operation depending on the software.

Practice 34

> “Press the **Escape key** to close the menu.”

「按 **Esc 鍵**關閉選單。」

Practice 35

> “You can cancel the command by pressing **Escape**.”

「你可以按 **Esc 鍵**取消這個指令。」

Escape key = 鍵盤上通常用來取消、退出或中止目前操作的 Esc 鍵

18. **escape room (娛樂活動) — 密室逃脫**

A useful modern compound.

Meaning: A game in which participants solve puzzles and clues to “escape” from a themed room within a time limit.

Practice 36

> “We tried an **escape room** for her birthday.”

「她生日那天, 我們玩了一次**密室逃脫**。」

Practice 37

> “The **escape room** was difficult but fun.”

「那個**密室逃脫遊戲**很困難, 但很好玩。」

escape room = 玩家在限時內解謎、找線索並完成「逃離」任務的實境遊戲

Important distinction: **escape vs leave**

leave

simply means go away from a place.

> “She left the building.”

「她離開了大樓。」

escape

implies that there was:

- * danger,
- * confinement,
- * control,
- * something unpleasant,
- * or something you wanted to get away from.

> “She escaped from the burning building.”

「她從失火的大樓**逃生**。」

So **escape** carries a much stronger idea of **getting free**.

Important distinction: **escape vs avoid**

escape

often means the danger/problem was close or already affecting you, but you got free from it.

avoid

means prevent contact with it in the first place.

> “He avoided the traffic by leaving early.”

「他提早出發，避開了交通擠塞。」

> “He escaped the traffic jam by taking a side road.”

「他走小路，成功擺脫了交通擠塞。」

The difference is not absolute, but this is a useful tendency.

Important distinction: **escape vs flee**

escape

focuses on successfully getting free.

flee

focuses on quickly running/leaving because of danger or fear.

> “Residents fled the fire.”

「居民因火災迅速逃離。」

> “Several residents escaped from the burning building.”

「幾名居民成功從失火大樓逃生。」

flee does not necessarily tell us whether the escape was ultimately successful.

Important distinction: **escape vs relief**

In your sentence, these are related but not identical.

escape

emphasizes:

temporarily getting away from the source of stress

relief

emphasizes:

the pleasant feeling produced when stress, pain, or worry decreases

So:

> “The headphones provided an escape.”

= 耳機讓我暫時抽離壓力。

> “The headphones gave me relief.”

= 耳機令我感到壓力減輕、如釋重負。

Important distinction: **escape vs escapism**

an escape

can be healthy and temporary:

> “Music gives me a short escape from work.”

「音樂讓我暫時從工作抽離一下。」

escapism

often suggests a broader habit of using fantasy or entertainment to avoid unpleasant reality.

It can be neutral, positive, or mildly critical depending on context.

So your sentence:

> “a small escape from everyday chaos”

does **not** automatically criticize the person as practising **escapism**.

Important distinction: **escape from** vs **escape something**

Both occur, but the object changes.

escape from + place/person

> “escape from prison”

「從監獄逃走」

escape + unpleasant event/consequence

> “escape injury”

「逃過受傷」

> “escape punishment”

「逃過懲罰」

escape + notice/memory

> “escape notice”

「沒有被注意到」

> “His name escapes me.”

「我一時想不起他的名字。」

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, these are especially useful:

- * **escape from danger** = 逃離危險
- * **escape injury/punishment** = 逃過受傷／懲罰
- * **escape notice** = 未被注意
- * **it escapes me** = 我一時想不起來
- * **an escape from stress** = 從壓力中短暫抽離
- * **narrow escape** = 驚險逃過一劫
- * **escape route** = 逃生路線
- * **fire escape** = 消防逃生梯／通道
- * **escapee** = 逃脫者
- * **escapism** = 逃避現實
- * **escapist entertainment** = 讓人暫時忘記現實的娛樂
- * **Escape key** = Esc 鍵
- * **escape room** = 密室逃脫

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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escape from danger/place	成功離開原本被困、受控制或存在危險的地方／處境
escape — get away	成功擺脫限制、追捕或危險並離開
escape injury/punishment	成功避免遭遇原本可能發生的傷害、危險或懲罰
escape notice/detection	某事存在，但沒有被別人注意或偵測出來
something escapes someone	某項資料原本可能知道，但當下就是想不起來
gas/liquid escapes	氣體、液體等從封閉地方意外洩漏或逸出
an escape — physical	從危險、受困或限制中成功離開的行動／事件
an escape from stress/routine	暫時從壓力、例行生活或不愉快現實中抽離並得到喘息
escape — recreation	用來暫時忘記現實壓力、獲得心理放鬆的活動
narrow escape	非常接近遭遇危險或事故，但最後僥倖避過
escape route	危險或緊急情況下供人離開某地的安全路線
fire escape	火警等緊急情況下供人離開建築物的專用逃生設施

escapee	已從監禁、拘留或其他受控制情況中逃走的人	
escapism	透過幻想或娛樂暫時避開現實問題和壓力的傾向	
escapist — adjective	主要用來讓人暫時忘記日常現實和壓力的	
escapist — person	習慣透過幻想等方式逃避現實問題的人	
Escape key	鍵盤上通常用來取消、退出或中止目前操作的 Esc 鍵	
escape room	玩家限時解謎並完成「逃離」任務的密室逃脫遊戲	

For your original sentence

> “The headphones seemed like a small **escape from everyday chaos**.”

The exact meaning is:

escape = 暫時從日常生活中的壓力、嘈雜和混亂中抽離，得到片刻心理放鬆和喘息

So:

a small escape from everyday chaos

= **從日常混亂中獲得的一點短暫喘息和私人空間**

It does **not** mean physically running away. It means the headphones temporarily made the person feel **less exposed to the stress and noise of everyday life**.